

VOLUME 1: THE WEFT BETWEEN WORLDS

TENSION

緊張



BATHYAL
COMICS



\$4.99 US

1

MAY 2025

VEXIS

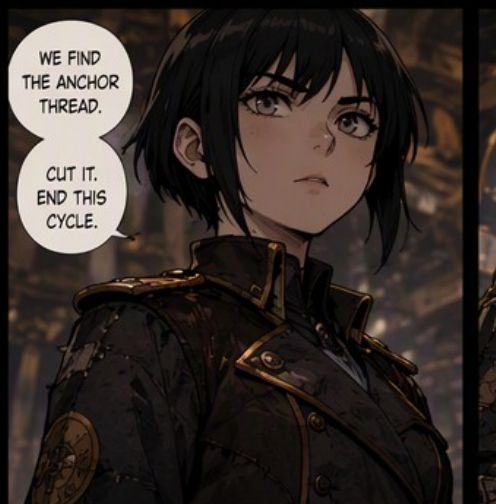
PULL HARD. HOLD FAST. SOME THREADS SHOULD NEVER BREAK.

THE ESCAPEMENT.

HEART OF THE CLOCKWORK.
CHAMBER OF RELENTLESS
PERPETUAL MOTION.

KLA-
KLAK

TICK
TOCK





MOTHER BATHYAL

SOVEREIGN OF THE LIQUEFIED ATMOSPHERE

SHE DOES
NOT BREATHE.

SHE CIRCULATES.

SHE REMEMBERS
WHAT THE WORLD
HAS FORGOTTEN.

SHE IS THE
PRESSURE BETWEEN
THE TICKS.

WELL.

THAT'S
NEW.

RENN.

OKAY, JELLYFISH
QUEEN.

YOU GONNA
EAT US, OR
LECTURE US?

'CAUSE I GOT
PLACES TO
BE.

TENSION-GAUNTLET SPOOL:
MODEL 12A "RATTLER"
PATCHED. DENTED. LOUD.

SLOANE.

IDENTIFY
YOURSELF.

AND STATE
YOUR CLAIM
TO THIS
CHAMBER.

ANCHORITE VANGUARD CADET (FORMER)
UNIFORM: STANDARD ISSUE
STATUS: STRIPPED. RE-STITCHED.

BIX.

I—I DON'T
THINK WE'RE
SUPPOSED TO
BE HERE.

I MEAN—

I THINK.

MAYBE.

PROBABLY.

OH NO.

CLOCKWORK SCRIPTOR PACK: V2.3
SYNCING... (OVERCLOCKED)
USER: BIX (14)
CONDITION: ANXIOUS.

YOU STAND IN THE
INTERSTITIAL.

FEW DO.

YOU ARE NOT
UNWELCOME.

YOU ARE...
INTERESTING.

LET US
TALK—

—BEFORE THE
NEXT TURNING.

THE GEARS REMAIN UNMOVED.
THE TIME, UNBOtherED.

TO BE CONTINUED...

CHAPTER 17:
DEPTHS OF TIME
PART IV

RHYTHM IS THE ONLY
THING THAT KEEPS
THE DROWNED WORLD
FROM DROWNING
US ALL.

HOLD THE
BEAT—OR BE
SWEEP AWAY.

PENDULUM
SWING IN
3... 2...

FLOOR SHIFT
RIGHT—NOW!

ANGLE
SEVENTEEN.
WEIGHT
COMPENSATED.

TUNING
BATONS
LOCKED ON
THIRD HARM-
ONIC!

TENSION
SPOOL
ONLINE!

LET'S SEE
IF YOU CAN
DANCE!

MOTHER
BATHYAL

KEEPER OF THE
SUNKEN CHAMBER.
BREATHES GOLD.
MOVES LIKE
DROWNING.

HOW SWEET.
CHILDREN PLAYING
AT KEEPING TIME.

LET US SEE
HOW LONG YOUR
RHYTHM LASTS.

PENDULUM
ENGAGED.

KLANK

FLOOR
REALIGNED.

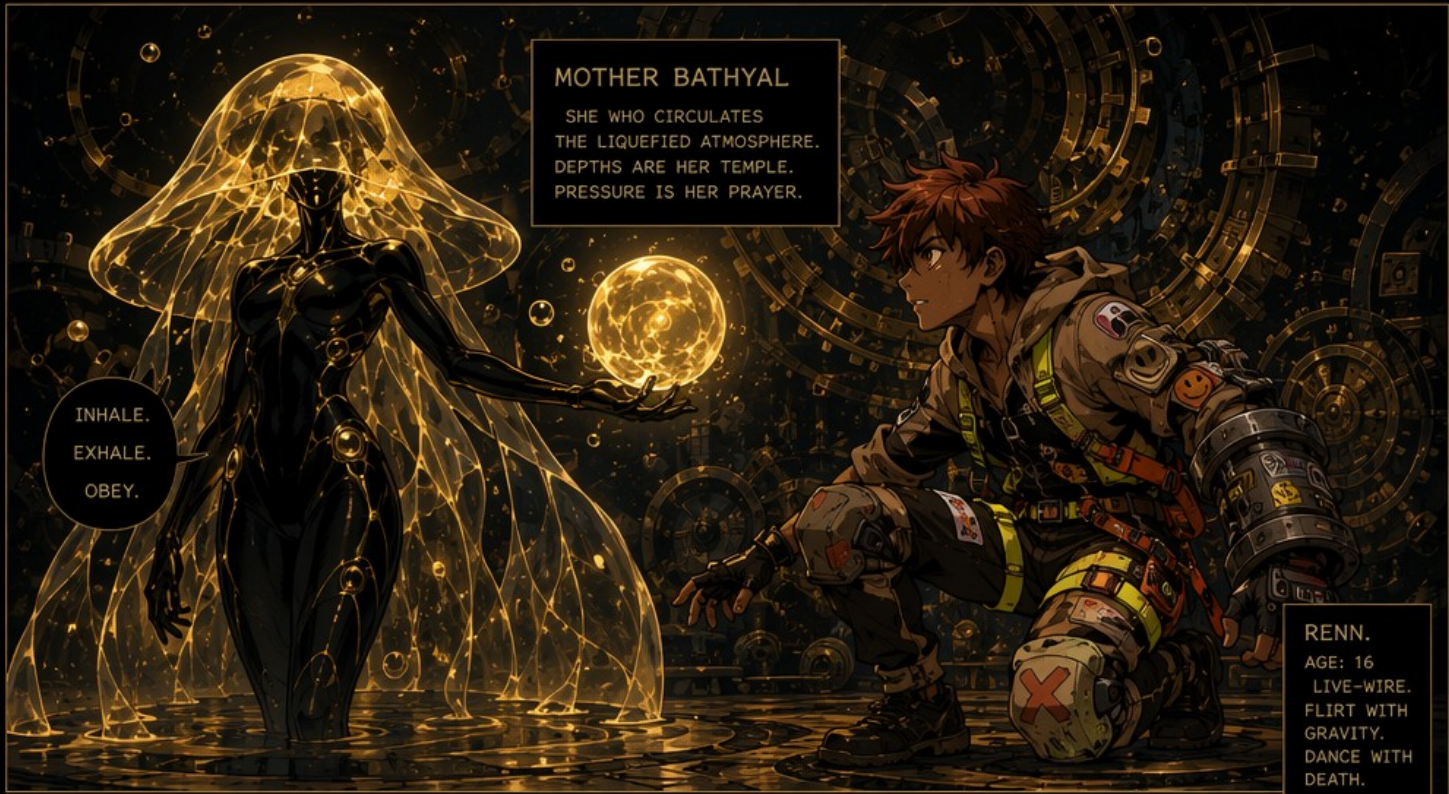
CHK-
CHK-
CHK!

TENSION
MAINTAINED.

WHRRR
RRRR!

THREE
HEARTBEATS.

ONE
RHYTHM.

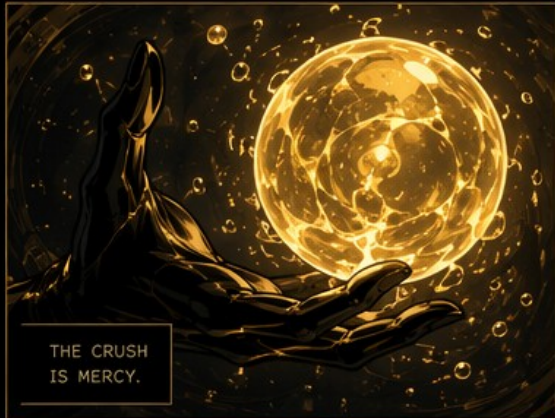


MOTHER BATHYAL

SHE WHO CIRCULATES
THE LIQUEFIED ATMOSPHERE.
DEPTHS ARE HER TEMPLE.
PRESSURE IS HER PRAYER.

INHALE.
EXHALE.
OBEY.

RENN.
AGE: 16
LIVE-WIRE.
FLIRT WITH
GRAVITY.
DANCE WITH
DEATH.



THE CRUSH
IS MERCY.



HEH!



EVEN MACHINES
HOLD THEIR BREATH.

RESISTANCE
IS NOT DEFIANCE.
IT IS RITUAL.



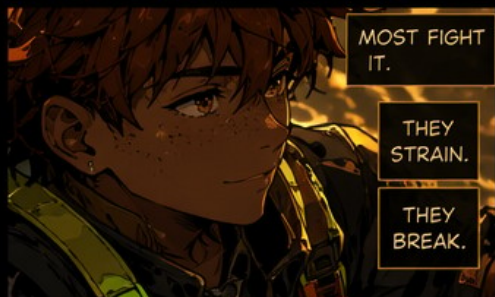


MOTHER
BATHYAL
DOES NOT
ATTACK.

SHE
ADVANCES.

AND THE
PRESSURE
FOLLOWS.
A SECOND
WAVE.

CRUSHING.



MOST FIGHT
IT.

THEY
STRAIN.

THEY
BREAK.



NOT
RENN.

HE
LETS
GO.



TENSION
DISSIPATES.

THE WAVE
FINDS NO
ANCHOR.



PRESSURE
WITHOUT
PURPOSE...

CANNOT
CRUSH.

IT FOLLOWS
ITS NATURE.

AND HE
FOLLOWS
HIS.



CALM

IS NOT
ABSENCE.

IT IS
ALIGNMENT.



THE WEFT-LINE
IS NOT A WEAPON.

IT IS
UNDERSTANDING.



MOTHER
BATHYAL
KNOWS
THIS.

THAT IS
WHY SHE
RETREATS.



THE ABYSS
RESPECTS
BALANCE.

AND BALANCE...

RESPECTS
RENN.

THE ESCAPEMENT

CHAMBER OF SHARED PULSE

BIX.
FOURTEEN.
TUNER OF
IMPOSSIBLE
THINGS.

TICK
TICK

TICK

HE DOESN'T
FIX MACHINES.
HE ARGUES
WITH THEM.

THE PULSE
IS A PROMISE.
KEEP IT TRUE,
AND THE WORLD
OBEYS.

MISS IT,
AND IT
EATS YOU.

...HESITATES.

HESST

HALF A BEAT.
THAT'S ALL.
THAT'S ALL IT
EVER TAKES.

SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.
DAUGHTER OF
A FALLEN HOUSE.
VANGUARD
IN ALL BUT
NAME NOW.

SHE DOESN'T
BELIEVE IN
LUCK.
SHE BELIEVES
IN POSITIONING.

JUST ENOUGH
TIME.
JUST ENOUGH
SPACE.
JUST ENOUGH
DISCIPLINE.

THEN THE
FLOOR TURNS
AWAY.
MISTAKE,
AND THERE'S
NOTHING
LEFT.

KRRR-CHAKK!

BIX PUSHES
HARDER.
SWEAT.
SHAKES.
FOCUS.
HE DROWNS OUT
EVERYTHING
BUT THE
PULSE.

COME ON,
YOU STUBBORN
OLD THING...
COME ON...
BACK TO
TRUE...

TA-CHK

THE PENDULUM
CATCHES.
THE PULSE
REALIGNS.
THE CHAMBER
BREATHES.

NOT PERFECT.
BUT TRUE.
FOR NOW.



MOTHER BATHYAL

DEPTH: 10,000M

PRESSURE: 1,000 ATM



TICK.

...

TICK.

...

TICK.

...

TICK.

...

TICK.

...





THE RESONANCE
SHOULDN'T BE
... HARMFUL TO CODA.

HE'S ADAPTED TO
WORSE FREQUENCIES
THAN THIS.



TTRR...

TTRR...

BUT THE CHAMBER'S
ACOUSTIC STRAIN IS
CLIMBING... FAST.



HIS GEOMETRY IS
UNSTABLE. THE
HARMONICS ARE
TEARING AT HIM.

HKK...

HKK...



THE LIGHT THAT
ONCE SOOTHED
THIS PLACE...

...IS BEING
FORCED INTO
SOMETHING
ELSE.

KRRK!



NOT WARMTH.
NOT WONDER.

SOMETHING
RAW.



SOMETHING
THAT HURTS.

SKREEEEEEE!!!



CODA?!



?!



WHATEVER THIS
IS... IT'S NO LONGER
OUR CODA.



RENN.

TENSION-GAUNTLET
SPOOL: ARCLIGHT-9
3.2 KM MICROFILAMENT
27% REMAINING

HER SHRIEK
IS A KNIFE MADE
OF PRESSURE.

?!

KREEEEEEEE!

CODA'S VOICE
TEARS THROUGH
THE CHAMBER—
FERAL. WRONG.

MY FOCUS
BREAKS.
JUST FOR
A BREATH.

MOTHER BATHYAL.
SHE DOESN'T RUSH.
SHE IS THE CURRENT.

HER SUIT DOESN'T
CARRY AIR.
IT CARRIES
A LIQUEFIED SKY.

SHE CLOSES THE
DISTANCE FASTER
THAN BEFORE.

BACK UP.
KEEP SPACE.
KEEP CONTROL.

BREATHE.
READ.
REACT—

TOO LATE.

SHE DOESN'T
NEED TO HURRY.
I DO.

GHH—!

BIX'S CONCENTRATION
FALTERS.

THE CHAMBER'S
RHYTHM LURCHES.
UNPREDICTABLE.

AND SHE
KEEPS COMING.



THE CHAMBER
BREAKS.

BODIES FALL.

POWER
SCREAMS.

HMNN...

ECHO HUMS.

CODA LISTENS.



STAY WITH
MY MELODY,
CODA.

NOT THEIR
CHAOS.



SKREEEE!

CODA SHRIEKS.
LIGHT
OUT OF
CONTROL.



HMNNN...

ECHO'S HUM
THREADS THROUGH
THE STATIC.

SLOWLY.
PATIENTLY.



THE SHRIEK
FALTERS.

KKH...!



THE LIGHT
EASES.

...HHH...



RETURNING
TO WARMTH.
TO HOME.

...HMNN.
♡



THERE.

THAT'S MY
GOOD BOY.

OUTSIDE, THE WORLD
FALLS APART.

IN HERE, WE
RESONATE.

CODA'S
SHRIEKING FADES
BEHIND ME.

FOCUS.

FIND THE
RHYTHM.

AAAAAAHHH!

THE CHAMBER
LURCHES.

THEN SETTLES.

A PULSE I CAN
HOLD.

STEADY.

STEADY.

LIKE
A HEART.

TICK.

TICK.

TICK.

ACROSS THE
SHIFTING FLOOR,

SLOANE.

ANCHORITE
VANGUARD
CADET.

ARISTOCRATIC
DISCIPLINE
IN A RUINED
UNIFORM.

A GLANCE.

THANKFUL.

I DON'T NOD.
I DON'T SMILE.
I KEEP THE PULSE.

THAT'S HOW WE
BOTH SURVIVE.

DEEP WITHIN
THE ESCAPEMENT--

--A COLOSSAL
GEAR SLIPS
OUT OF
ALIGNMENT.

KRRNNNNCH!

THE SHOCKWAVE
TEARS THROUGH
THE CHAMBER.
ORDER COLLAPSES.



RENN

WHOA!
THAT'S...
NOT GOOD.

SLOANE

MAINTAIN
YOUR
CENTERS.
THE
ESCAPEMENT
PUNISHES
HESITATION.

BIX

I--I CAN'T
STABILIZE
THE BACKFLOW!
THE PRESSURE
IS SPIKING!

MOTHER
BATHYAL

THE CURRENT
DOES NOT
FAVOR US.
ADAPT.



THE CHAMBER OF
TIDES.

HEART OF THE
BATHYAL CORE.

DEPTH: UNKNOWN.
PRESSURE: CRITICAL.
RHYTHM: FAILING.

WHOA!

RENN.

WATCH YOUR
LEFT.

Y-YOU
TOO.

...

K.R. R N N N N N C H H ---



SHE MOVES WITH A SLOW, DELIBERATE FLUIDITY AS IF PERMANENTLY UNDERWATER.

HER SUIT CIRCULATES A LIQUEFIED, GOLDEN ATMOSPHERE RATHER THAN AIR.

CATCHING HER BALANCE AS THE CHAMBER'S RHYTHM FINALLY BEGINS TO STABILIZE.

SHE LOOKS ONCE MORE AT RENN—

—IN SILENCE.

HER POSTURE NO LONGER CERTAIN THE WAY IT WAS WHEN SHE FIRST ARRIVED.



THEN SHE TURNS.

AND WITHDRAWS DEEPER INTO THE SURROUNDING MECHANISM WITHOUT A WORD.

HER RETREAT UNHURRIED BUT UNMISTAKABLY SHAKEN.

DISAPPEARING INTO THE SHADOWS BETWEEN THE GEARS.





WE MADE IT.
THE WOUND'S QUIET.
SOON... IT WON'T BE.

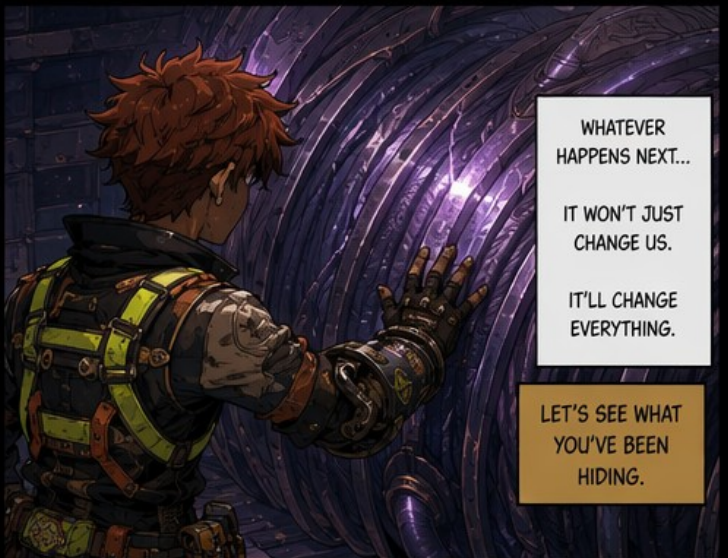
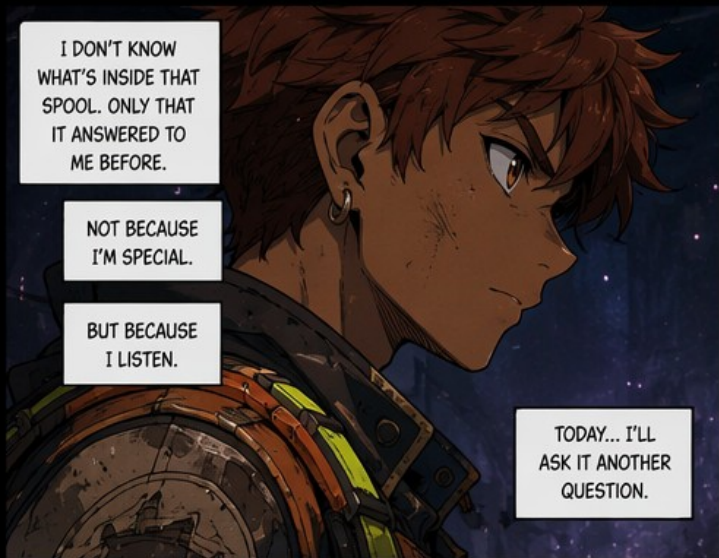
THIS CHAMBER WAS NEVER ON ANY MAP.
THE ANCHORITES BUILT SECRETS INTO THEIR SECRETS.

I-I DON'T LIKE HOW QUIET IT IS...
LIKE... IT'S WAITING FOR SOMETHING.



THE WOUND MECHANISM.
THE HEART OF THE ANCHORITE VANGUARD.

IT HOLDS THE TENSION BETWEEN WORLDS.
KEEPING THEM APART.
OR... TEARING THEM TOGETHER.



I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S INSIDE THAT SPOOL. ONLY THAT IT ANSWERED TO ME BEFORE.
NOT BECAUSE I'M SPECIAL.
BUT BECAUSE I LISTEN.

TODAY... I'LL ASK IT ANOTHER QUESTION.

WHATEVER HAPPENS NEXT...
IT WON'T JUST CHANGE US.
IT'LL CHANGE EVERYTHING.
LET'S SEE WHAT YOU'VE BEEN HIDING.

To Be Continued...

✦ EPISODE 1: TENSION ✦

